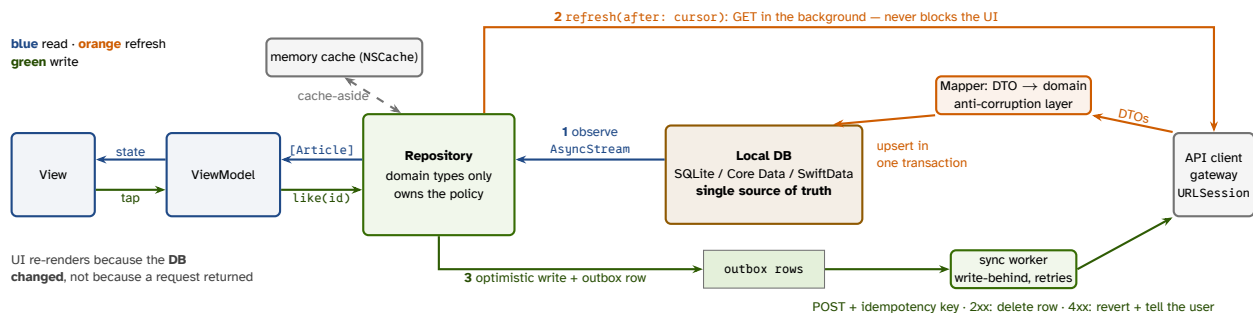


In one line: A Repository is only the *front door*. Behind it: **DTOs** mapped to domain models at an **anti-corruption** edge, a local **DB as the single source of truth** the UI *observes*, a network **gateway** that only *refreshes* it, a **unit of work** committing changes together, a **cache policy** per data type, and **cursors** for paging. Offline-first: reads never wait for the network; writes go through an outbox.



How it works

- Repository vs DAO**: a DAO/data source is CRUD over *one* store; a Repository is a collection-like API over *domain* objects hiding *several* sources and the policy between them.
- DTO ↔ domain**: the DTO mirrors the wire (optionals, server names); the domain model is valid by construction. Map once, at the edge: that mapper is the **Anti-Corruption Layer** (Evans) — a foreign model (backend JSON, a vendor SDK) never leaks inward, so an API rename stops at one file.
- Data Mapper vs Active Record** (Fowler): AR = the object carries its own persistence (`row.save()`; GRDB's `try player.insert(db)` is AR-style); DM = a separate mapper moves data, the domain type knows nothing of storage (plain `struct ↔ NSManagedObject`).
- Unit of Work** = track every change of a business transaction, commit together. `NSManagedObjectContext` is one (`insertedObjects`, `updatedObjects`, `deletedObjects`, `hasChanges`, `save()`, `rollback()`) and an **Identity Map** (uniquing: one object per record per context). `SwiftData`'s `ModelContext`: `insert`, `delete`, `save()`; `autosave` only on the container's main context — a context you create yourself must `save()`.
- Specification** (Evans/Fowler) = a composable predicate object (`isSatisfied(by:)`, `and/or/not`); **Query Object** = a query as data. Apple: `NSPredicate`, `#Predicate` (translated to SQL), `NSFetchRequest`, `FetchDescriptor` (`fetchLimit`, `fetchOffset`).
- Gateway** (Fowler) = one object wrapping *one external system* in your terms (API client, `PaymentGateway` over an SDK). A Repository *uses* gateways.

Example — the edges, in code

```
struct ArticleDTO: Decodable { let id: String // wire shape
  let title: String?; let publishedAt: Date } // .iso8601
struct Article: Identifiable, Hashable { // domain shape
  let id: String; let title: String; let published: Date }
extension Article { init?(_ d: ArticleDTO) { // the ACL edge
  guard let t = d.title, !t.isEmpty else { return nil }
  self.init(id: d.id, title: t, published: d.publishedAt) } }
struct Cursor: Hashable, Sendable { let token: String } // opaque
protocol ArticleRepository: Sendable {
  func articles() -> AsyncStream<Article> // observe the SSOT
  func refresh(after: Cursor?) async throws -> Cursor? // nil: end
  func like(_ id: Article.ID) async throws // DB now, API later
```

Remember

DTO at the edge · domain inside · DB is the truth · network only refreshes · writes go through the outbox · page by cursor.

Cache strategies on a phone

Strategy	Mechanism	iOS use · risk
Cache-aside	get; miss → load → put	NSCache before an image/API call · stale until TTL; miss stampede → share one in-flight Task per key
Read-through	the cache loads a miss itself	≈ URLCache in URLSession (Cache-Control) · cache must know the source
Write-through	write store <i>and</i> cache, then return	settings edits · slower writes, always consistent
Write-behind	write locally, flush later in batches	the outbox + sync worker · lost if not persisted; conflicts
Stale-while-revalidate	show cached now, refresh in background	every SSOT screen (RFC 5861, HTTP) · show "updating"

Single source of truth + paging

- SSOT**: the UI observes the DB, the network writes *into* it, the view model never keeps its own copy — offline and online share one code path.
- Offset** (?page=3, `fetchOffset`): an insert shifts every page → duplicates/skips; cost grows with the offset.
- Cursor/keyset** (?after=<opaque>): stable under inserts; the repository stores next beside the rows, `nil` = end; the VM only calls `loadMore()`.

Traps

- ! DTOs or `NSManagedObjects` in the UI: API shape + persistence leak everywhere.
- ! `NSManagedObject` is bound to its context's queue — pass `NSManagedObjectID`, or map to structs.
- ! Optimistic update without a persisted outbox: kill the app, lose the write.
- ! Two sources of truth (VM array + DB) drift — observe, don't copy.
- ! Offset paging on a live feed = duplicate rows.